

April

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1930 African emperor

Haile Selassie became emperor of Ethiopia. A forward-thinking ruler, Selassie created modern Ethiopia, abolishing slavery and setting up the country's first written constitution.

Also on this day

1513 Spanish explorer **Juan Ponce de León** first saw land in what is now Florida, USA.

1851 Rama IV became the king of Siam (modern-day Thailand). He ruled until 1868.

1982 Argentina launched a military operation to capture the British-controlled Falkland Islands in the South Atlantic, triggering the Falklands War.



1877 Fired!

The first human cannonball act was performed by 14-year-old British acrobat Rossa Matilda Richter, known as Zazel, at the Royal Aquarium in London, UK.

Born this day

1805 Hans Christian Andersen, Danish author. He is best known for writing *The Little Mermaid*. His birthday is now celebrated as International Children's Book Day.

1939 Marvin Gaye, Black American singer and songwriter. The soul and R&B music he produced has influenced many other artists.

1931

Pitching a curve ball

One of the first women to play professional baseball, pitcher Jackie Mitchell shocked fans by striking out superstar hitters Babe Ruth and Lou Gehrig during a game in Tennessee, USA.

